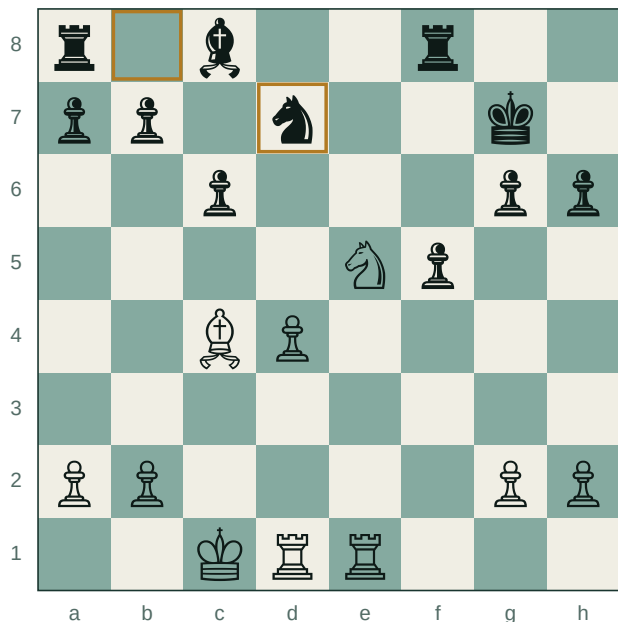


Clearance tactics: White, move 19

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 18...Nd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Nxd7 Bxd7 20. Re7+ Kf6 21. Rxd7

19.Nxd7 The knight captures the knight on d7. Recorded reply: **19...Bxd7**.

20.Re7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From e7 it attacks king on g7 and bishop on d7. Recorded reply: **20...Kf6**.

21.Rxd7 The rook captures the bishop on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g7. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.